ICSE 2027 · GEOGRAPHY (H.C.G. PAPER 2)

Question Bank

Climate · Soil Resources · Waste Management

Built from every Geography paper in your project: board papers T23, T24, T25 and specimen papers T24, T26, T27 (T = year, 502 = Geography). Format follows the T27 Specimen: Section A is MCQs (Question 3 style, 1 mark each); Section B is full 10-mark Part II questions with parts (i) to (iv) carrying 2, 2, 3 and 3 marks; Section C is map work. Each question carries its source, so you can check the official marking scheme for the T26 and T27 specimens.

How to use: attempt each question cold and timed (about 12 minutes per 10-mark question), mark yourself, and log every lost mark. The tracker in Section D shows what the board repeats most; do those first.

SECTION A: Multiple Choice Questions

Choose the correct answers. (Do not copy the question, write the correct answers only.)

A1. Climate of India [6 marks]

(1) The place that is likely to experience less rainfall from June to September is: *[T27 Specimen]*

(a) Kochi
(b) Goa
(c) Mumbai
(d) Chennai

(2) The Himalayas have a significant impact on the climate of India as they: *[T26 Specimen]*

(a) block the N.E. monsoon winds.
(b) cause rainfall in the Gangetic plains.
(c) create a rain shadow area in the Deccan plateau.
(d) cause cyclonic disturbance in the Bay of Bengal.

(3) Assertion (A): Mumbai receives more rainfall than Pune. Reason (R): Mumbai gets rain from the Arabian Sea branch of the southwest monsoon. *[T25]*

(a) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation for (A).
(b) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is not the correct explanation for (A).
(c) (A) is true and (R) is false.
(d) (A) is false and (R) is true.

(4) What causes snowfall in Kashmir during winter? *[T24]*

(a) Tropical cyclone
(b) Northeast Monsoon wind
(c) Southwest Monsoon wind
(d) Temperate cyclone

(5) Which of the following is the CORRECT set of water bodies from which the Southwest monsoon picks up moisture? *[T24 Specimen]*

(a) Arabian Sea + Bay of Bengal + Indian Ocean
(b) Indian Ocean + Andaman Sea + Arabian Sea
(c) Bay of Bengal + Indian Ocean + Andaman Sea
(d) Gulf of Mannar + Mediterranean Sea + Indian Ocean

(6) Which of the following areas receives rain from the North East Monsoon? *[T23]*

(a) Konkan coast
(b) Ganga basin
(c) Coromandel coast
(d) Malabar coast

A2. Soil Resources [6 marks]

(1) Black soil : Maharashtra :: Red soil : _____ *[T27 Specimen]*

(a) Uttar Pradesh
(b) Bihar
(c) Odisha
(d) Punjab

(2) Ex-situ soil found in India is _____. *[T26 Specimen]*

(a) Alluvial soil
(b) Black soil
(c) Laterite soil
(d) Red soil

(3) Which of the following pairs of soils displays similar characteristics in terms of their colour and texture? *[T25]*

(a) Alluvial soil and laterite soil
(b) Black soil and red soil
(c) Red soil and laterite soil
(d) Alluvial soil and black soil

(4) Which of the following helps in soil conservation? *[T24]*

(a) Afforestation
(b) Overgrazing
(c) Mining
(d) Shifting agriculture

(5) Feel and consistency of soil is called _____ of the soil. *[T24 Specimen]*

(a) Profile
(b) Parent rock
(c) Texture
(d) Nature

(6) Which is the most widespread soil of India? *[T23]*

(a) Red soil
(b) Alluvial soil
(c) Laterite soil
(d) Black soil

A3. Waste Management [5 marks]

(1) Which of the following bags will take the longest time to degenerate and degrade? *[T27 Specimen]*

(a) Cloth bag
(b) Jute bag
(c) Paper bag
(d) Plastic bag

(2) The collection of discarded materials and converting them into useful products is: *[T25]*

(a) Recycling
(b) Processing
(c) Reducing
(d) Composting

(3) Which of the following is a biodegradable waste? *[T24]*

(a) Broken glass
(b) Wastepaper
(c) Polythene
(d) Plastic bags

(4) What is the depletion of oxygen in a water body resulting from pollution called? *[T24 Specimen]*

(a) Decay of water
(b) Eutrophication
(c) Bio magnification
(d) Greenhouse effect

(5) Which of the following methods of waste disposal is harmful? *[T23]*

(a) Composting
(b) Segregation
(c) Dumping
(d) Vermicomposting

Picture-based MCQ not reproduced: T26 Specimen Q3(x), the best disposal method for the waste shown. Open the original paper for it.

SECTION B: Part II Questions [10 marks each]

B1. Climate of India

Question 1 | Source: T27 Specimen, Q4

(i) **[2]**

(a) Why does monsoon begin to retreat after September?

(b) Which is the first state to receive rain from the South-West monsoon winds?

(ii) Name the branch of the South-West Monsoon wind that brings rain to each of the following regions: **[2]**

(a) Windward slope of Khasi Hills

(b) Western slopes of Western Ghats

(iii) Give a reason for each of the following: **[3]**

(a) Interior parts of the Deccan Plateau receive low annual rainfall.

(b) The hills of peninsular India are devoid of snow.

(c) It is difficult to hold a cricket match in Chennai in the winter season.

(iv) Study the climatic data of station X and answer the questions that follow: **[3]**

Month	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec
Temp (°C)	9	16.5	24.3	30.4	35.2	33.8	27.2	28.4	27.1	22	16.4	10.7
Rainfall (cm)	15	12.9	4.7	4.9	11.4	61.7	240	261	124	55.8	1.2	9.9

(a) In which month does the station receive maximum rainfall?

(b) Calculate the annual range of temperature.

(c) Why do you think the temperature drops significantly in the month of July?

Question 2 | Source: T26 Specimen, Q4

(i) "The climate in different parts of India is largely impacted by the relief features." Explain the above statement with the help of two suitable examples. **[2]**

(ii) What is the source of winter rainfall in each of the following areas? **[2]**

(a) Punjab

(b) Tamil Nadu

(iii) Give a reason for each of the following: **[3]**

(a) Kerala gets rainfall from the summer monsoons much before Uttar Pradesh.

(b) Vishakhapatnam records a low annual range of temperature.

(c) Winds are mostly offshore during the cold season.

(iv) Study the climatic data of station X and answer the following questions: **[3]**

Month	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec
Temp (°C)	25	25.5	26.3	27.1	30	36.2	36	35.9	30.3	28.4	27	24.6
Rainfall (cm)	24.5	23.1	15	2.4	0.1	11	9.3	7.2	4	9.4	14.5	20.4

(a) Calculate the average temperature of station X for the summer season only.

(b) Which is the driest month?

(c) Name the wind that brings maximum rainfall to this station.

Question 3 | Source: T25, Q4

(i) 'Severe cyclonic storms are often formed over the Bay of Bengal during the retreating monsoon season.' **[2]**

(a) Name two states that are affected by tropical cyclones on the eastern coast of India.

(b) The temperate cyclones cause less damage than the tropical cyclones. Give any two points to support this statement.

(ii) **[2]**

(a) Name the local wind that causes rainfall in the states of Assam and West Bengal in the month of April.

(b) How is this rainfall beneficial for the states mentioned above?

(iii) With reference to Figure A and Figure B (wind diagrams: see T25 502 paper, Q4(iii)), answer the questions that follow: **[3]**

(a) Name the winds shown by arrows in Figure A and Figure B.

(b) How is the wind shown in Figure A different from the one shown in Figure B?

(iv) Study the climate data of station X and answer the following questions: (– means no rainfall) **[3]**

Month	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec
Temp (°C)	24	25.4	26.7	28.3	30	28.9	27.6	27.4	27.3	27.1	27	25
Rainfall (cm)	0.25	0.25	–	–	1.75	50.2	61	37	27	4.75	1.5	–

(a) What is the annual range of temperature for station X?

(b) Which is the wettest month?

(c) Name the wind which brings rainfall for station X during the rainy season.

Question 4 | Source: T24, Q4

(i) 'Himalayas act as a climatic divide.' Justify the statement giving two reasons. **[2]**

(ii) Differentiate between Southwest Monsoon and Retreating Monsoon. (Any two differences) **[2]**

(iii) Give a geographical reason for the following: **[3]**

(a) Kolkata gets more rain than Delhi during rainy season.

(b) Though both are hill stations, Shimla experiences snowfall during the winters but Ooty does not.

(c) Winter monsoons bring less rain.

(iv) Study the climate data of Station X and answer the questions that follow: (– means no data given) **[3]**

Month	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec
Temp (°C)	8.4	11.5	21.6	28.3	35.1	38.5	41	38	30.8	29.2	15.6	10.2
Rainfall (cm)	1.5	0.9	0.5	–	–	12.5	17.8	18.5	12.5	12.5	6.2	2.1

(a) Calculate the annual range of temperature of Station X.

(b) Name the rainiest month of Station X.

(c) Is Station X located in a coastal area or in the continental interior?

Question 5 | Source: T24 Specimen, Q4

(i) "The southwest monsoon is late this year. The IMD on Tuesday, May 16, had predicted that the onset of southwest monsoon is delayed by four days. An agricultural economy, India is heavily reliant on the monsoon which brings 75 percent of its annual rainfall." — Indian Express **[2]**

(a) As a student of Geography, what according to you may be the reason for the delay of monsoon?

(b) What is the usual time for the onset of summer monsoon in Kerala?

(ii) What is the source of winter rainfall in the following areas? **[2]**

(a) Punjab

(b) Tamil Nadu

(iii) Give a reason for each of the following: **[3]**

(a) West Bengal gets rainfall from summer monsoons much before Uttar Pradesh.

(b) Mawsynram is the rainiest place in the world.

(c) Himalayas act as a climate divide.

(iv) Study the climatic data of station X and answer the following questions: **[3]**

Month	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec
Temp (°C)	23.1	24.8	26.5	29.3	32	32.8	33.1	32.1	30.5	29.3	28.7	26.1
Rainfall (cm)	15.3	10.1	0.3	0.1	1.3	4.5	6.1	10.2	10.5	20.1	16.8	19

(a) What is the annual range of temperature of station X?

(b) Which is the driest month?

(c) Name the wind that brings maximum rainfall to this station.

Question 6 | Source: T23, Q4

(i) Name the seasons of India and mention the duration of each season. **[2]**

(ii) Why does maximum rainfall in India occur after the summer season? **[2]**

(iii) Give a geographical reason for each of the following: **[3]**

(a) The Malabar coast receives heavy rainfall in the month of July but the Coromandel coast during this time remains comparatively dry.

(b) Punjab receives rainfall in winter season.

(c) Mumbai is warmer than Delhi in the month of December.

(iv) Study the climate data of Station X and answer the questions that follow: **[3]**

Month	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec
Temp (°C)	21	21.9	24.3	27.2	28	26.4	26.1	25.4	26	26	23.8	21.2
Rainfall (cm)	5.1	2.8	1.2	1.7	3.9	4.6	8.4	11.4	11.9	31.6	34.5	14.8

(a) Calculate the annual range of temperature of Station X.

(b) Name the wind that brings most of the rainfall to this station.

(c) On which coast of India is Station X located?

B2. Soil Resources

Question 1 | Source: T27 Specimen, Q5

(i) Explain how conservation of soil helps in the conservation of the following: **[2]**
- (a) Forests
- (b) Groundwater reserve

(ii) State any two similarities between red soil and laterite soil. **[2]**

(iii) With reference to Black Soil, answer the following questions: **[3]**
- (a) How does its mode of formation determine its name?
- (b) Mention two minerals that this soil is rich in.
- (c) Why is this soil called an in-situ soil?

(iv) Give a reason for each of the following statements: **[3]**
- (a) Farmers prefer soil that is rich in humus.
- (b) Rice can be cultivated in red soil only if irrigation is provided.
- (c) Khadar soil can hold more moisture than Bhangar.

Question 2 | Source: T26 Specimen, Q5

(i) Nathu, a farmer in Bihar, does not get good yields as the soil he tills is coarse and has a fair proportion of kankars. Motilal on the other hand has his field closer to the river and gets better yields. **[2]**
- (a) Identify the two types of soil being discussed in the above passage.
- (b) Give a possible reason why Motilal benefits from having his field along the river banks.

(ii) With reference to soil erosion in India, answer the following questions. **[2]**
- (a) How does population pressure affect soil erosion?
- (b) Mention any two innovative agricultural techniques that can help to prevent soil erosion.

(iii) With reference to Red Soil, answer the following: **[3]**
- (a) How is it formed?
- (b) Why is it good for Dry Farming?
- (c) Name any two areas where it is found.

(iv) Give a reason for the following statements: **[3]**
- (a) Black Soil has self-ploughing property.
- (b) Laterite Soil is not suitable for cultivation.
- (c) Alluvial soil has varying texture.

Question 3 | Source: T25, Q5

(i) The Ganga Plain is known for its fertile soil. It is often referred to as the food bowl of India. This region supports a variety of crops such as rice, wheat, pulses, jute and sugarcane. **[2]**
- (a) Name the soil that is found in large parts of Ganga plain.
- (b) Give two properties of this soil which help it to produce a variety of crops.

(ii) **[2]**
- (a) What is meant by soil erosion?
- (b) Name any two agents of soil erosion.

(iii) Give a geographical reason to explain each of the following: **[3]**
- (a) Soil conservation is the need of the hour.
- (b) Red soil has a poor water retention capacity.
- (c) Laterite soils are infertile.

(iv) With reference to black soil of India, answer the following questions. **[3]**
- (a) How is this soil formed?
- (b) How is this soil able to retain moisture for a long period?
- (c) Mention any two minerals present in this soil.

Question 4 | Source: T24, Q5

(i) Why is Black soil found suitable for the production of cotton? (Any two points) **[2]**

(ii) Give one difference between each of the following: **[2]**

(a) Alluvial soil of Uttarakhand and alluvial soil of West Bengal.

(b) Transported soil and residual soil.

(iii) With reference to Laterite soil, answer the questions that follow: **[3]**

(a) How is Laterite soil formed?

(b) How can Laterite soil be made productive?

(c) Name one region where Laterite soil is found.

(iv) **[3]**

(a) Mention two causes of soil erosion in India.

(b) Mention a soil conservation method suitable for hilly areas.

Question 5 | Source: T24 Specimen, Q5

(i) Define the following terms: **[2]**

(a) Soil fertility

(b) Soil conservation

(ii) With reference to soil erosion in India answer the following questions. **[2]**

(a) State any two human activities that have led to soil erosion in India.

(b) Mention any two agricultural techniques that can help to prevent soil erosion.

(iii) With reference to Red Soil, answer the following: **[3]**

(a) How is it formed?

(b) Why is it good for Dry Farming?

(c) Name any two areas where it is found.

(iv) Give a reason for the following statements: **[3]**

(a) Black Soil has self-ploughing property.

(b) Laterite Soil is not suitable for cultivation.

(c) Alluvial soil is the most fertile soil.

Question 6 | Source: T23, Q5

(i) **[2]**

(a) Mention any two causes of soil erosion in India.

(b) Name two soil conservation methods that may be practised in arid (dry) regions.

(ii) Mention two characteristics of Black soil. **[2]**

(iii) Name the soil: **[3]**

(a) That is found on the summits of Eastern and Western Ghats.

(b) That is suitable for dry farming.

(c) That varies in texture.

(iv) Give a geographical reason for each of the following: **[3]**

(a) Terrace farming is an ideal soil conservation method for hilly areas.

(b) Khadar soils are preferred over Bhangar soils.

(c) Foothills of Himalayas have been affected by soil erosion.

B3. Waste Management

Question 1 | Source: T27 Specimen, Q12

(i) [Picture-based: see T27 502 paper] Refer to the picture of a household pit/bin converting kitchen and garden waste. **[2]**

(a) Identify the safe waste disposal method depicted in the picture.

(b) How does it convert waste to wealth?

(ii) What is the significance of 'Reduce' in the 3R's of sustainable waste management? **[2]**

(iii) **[3]**

(a) Name any two items of daily use that can be recycled.

(b) Explain two ways in which recycling is beneficial for the environment.

(iv) State three measures that can be taken at the household level to reduce solid waste generation. **[3]**

Question 2 | Source: T26 Specimen, Q12

(i) What is the impact of waste generation on the following? **[2]**

(a) Surface water

(b) Landscape

(ii) [Picture-based: see T26 502 paper] Study the picture and answer the questions that follow: **[2]**

(a) Name the method of waste disposal seen in the picture.

(b) Why is this method considered a harmful method of waste disposal?

(iii) A fire broke out at the Kochi city waste treatment plant. Thick clouds of toxic smoke engulfed the city. The waste at the plant also contained plastic and biomedical wastes, both of which on combustion are extremely harmful for the general health of people. — Economic Times, 10.03.2023 **[3]**

(a) Which method of waste management would have helped in reducing health hazards in the above case?

(b) Mention any one measure you can adopt in schools to reduce waste.

(c) State one way in which domestic waste can be made useful.

(iv) **[3]**

(a) What is composting?

(b) Enumerate two advantages of composting as a method of waste disposal.

Question 3 | Source: T25, Q12

(i) **[2]**

(a) Give a reason for a substantial rise of E-waste in India.

(b) What is dumping?

(ii) 'You cannot protect environment unless you empower people, you inform them and help them to understand that these resources are their own, that they must protect them.' — Wangari Maathai. As a responsible student how would you contribute to reduce and manage the waste generated in your surroundings? Explain by giving suitable examples. **[2]**

(iii) With reference to the 3Rs, give a term that best describes each of the following: **[3]**

(a) An empty soft drink can is used as a pen stand.

(b) Old scrap papers are used to manufacture handmade paper.

(c) No food is wasted in the household.

(iv) Give a reason for the following statements: **[3]**

(a) Organic manure should replace chemical fertilisers.

(b) There should be a ban on the use of polythene and plastic products.

(c) Manual handling of waste must be avoided.

Question 4 | Source: T24, Q12

(i) [Picture-based: see T24 502 paper] With reference to the picture, answer the questions that follow: **[2]**

(a) Which waste management method is depicted here?

(b) State one way in which this method may be implemented at our home.

(ii) Explain how waste accumulation can be harmful. (Any two points) **[2]**

(iii) Explain how waste generated in the following sectors may be made useful. (Give one example for each) **[3]**

(a) Household

(b) Industry

(c) Agriculture

(iv) **[3]**

(a) Give two uses of composting.

(b) Why are landfills set up far away from the city? (Any two reasons)

Question 5 | Source: T24 Specimen, Q12

(i) What is the impact of waste generation on the following? **[2]**

(a) Surface water

(b) Landscape

(ii) Why is dumping considered a harmful method of waste disposal? (Two points) **[2]**

(iii) A fire broke out at the Kochi city corporation-run waste treatment plant. Thick clouds of toxic smoke engulfed the city. The unsorted waste at the plant contained PVC and clinical waste, both of which on combustion are extremely harmful for the general health of people. — Economic Times **[3]**

(a) Which method of waste management would have helped in reducing health hazard in the above case?

(b) What measures may be undertaken by individuals to reduce waste?

(c) How can urban waste be made useful?

(iv) Mention three ways to reuse waste that is generated at home. **[3]**

Question 6 | Source: T23, Q12

(i) Why should Waste Management be practised in every school? **[2]**

(ii) Mention one advantage and one disadvantage of dumping of waste. **[2]**

(iii) Briefly answer the following: **[3]**

(a) How is segregation of the waste helpful?

(b) Mention one way in which we can reuse waste.

(c) Mention one benefit of Composting.

(iv) **[3]**

(a) How is recycling of waste helpful? Give an example of recycling of waste.

(b) Mention any one initiative taken by the Government to manage waste.

SECTION C: Map Work (Question 2 style, on the outline map of India)

(1) Mark and label the wind that brings rain to Mumbai in July. [T27 Specimen]

(2) Mark with arrows and name the wind which brings rainfall to the Konkan coast. [T26 Specimen]

(3) Mark with arrows and name the wind that brings rainfall to the Tamil Nadu coast during winter. [T25]

(4) Mark with an arrow and label the direction of the western disturbance. [T24]

(5) Mark with an arrow and label the N.E. Monsoon wind. [T24 Specimen]

(6) Mark with arrows and name the Southwest Monsoon winds. [T23]

(7) Shade and label an area of black soil. [T27 Specimen] / Shade and label an area of black soil in Gujarat. [T26 Specimen]

(8) Shade and label an alluvial soil area of India. [T24 Specimen] / Shade an area having alluvial soil. [T23]

SECTION D: Repeat Tracker (do these first)

Repeated topic	Where it appeared
Climate data question (annual range / rainiest, driest, wettest month / wind / coast)	All 6 papers
Winter rainfall source: Punjab and Tamil Nadu	T24 Spec, T26 Spec
Kerala / West Bengal receives summer monsoon before Uttar Pradesh	T24 Spec, T26 Spec
Himalayas as a climate divide / their effect on climate	T24, T24 Spec, T26 Spec (MCQ)
Black soil: self-ploughing, formation, minerals, moisture retention, in-situ	T24 Spec, T25, T26 Spec, T27 Spec
Laterite soil: not suitable for cultivation / infertile / how formed	T24, T24 Spec, T25, T26 Spec
Red soil: formation, dry farming, areas, water retention	T24 Spec, T25, T26 Spec, T27 Spec
Khadar vs Bhangar	T23, T26 Spec, T27 Spec
Causes of soil erosion and conservation methods	T23, T24, T24 Spec, T25, T26 Spec
Impact of waste generation on surface water and landscape	T24 Spec, T26 Spec
Dumping: why harmful / advantage and disadvantage	T23, T24 Spec, T26 Spec, T25
Kochi waste plant fire passage	T24 Spec, T26 Spec
Composting: meaning, uses, advantages	T23, T24, T26 Spec, T27 Spec
3Rs: Reduce, Reuse, Recycle	T23, T25, T27 Spec